

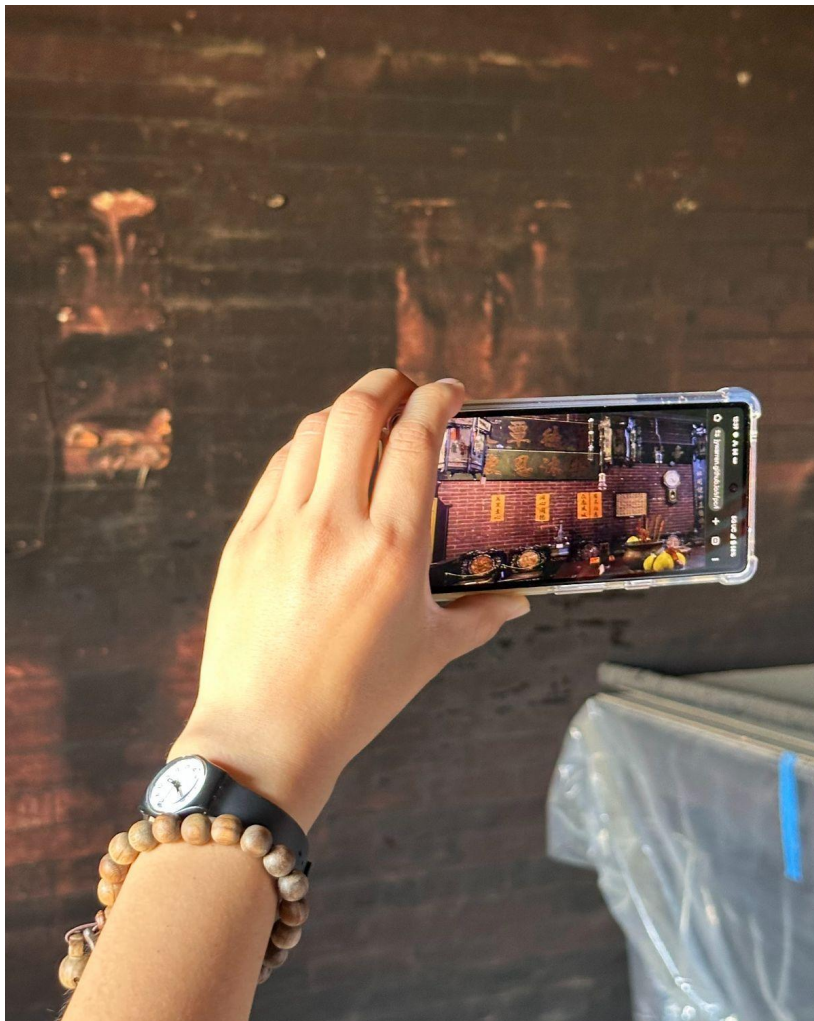
Jeffrey Yoo Warren

Portfolio | 2025



Seeing Lost Enclaves: Hidden Portals

At the sites of 5 historical erased communities of color, portals have been hidden in plain sight. When you approach, the portals open, allowing a glimpse into virtually reconstructed, immersive moments from their pasts which my collaborators and I spent the past two years crafting from archival records and photographs, oral histories and other clues. Hidden Portals is part of the Seeing Lost Enclaves project as 2023-24 Innovator in Residence at the Library of Congress.



Chinatown Archives: Relational Reconstructions

Evelyn Hang Yin and Jeffrey Yoo Warren are supported by the 1882 Foundation to develop community-engaged artworks and “relational reconstructions” of Hanford, CA’s China Alley. The two have been working with histories of Hanford’s China Alley to craft different kinds of reconstructions of this early, rural Chinese American community, including virtual reality works, papercraft and even wooden replicas of artifacts. Left, the reconstruction in augmented reality on a phone, at the present-day, fire-damaged upstairs of the Taoist Temple Museum, undergoing restoration.



Chinatown Archives: Relational Reconstructions

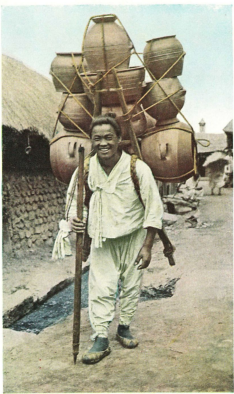
Looking for new ways to reconnect people with these histories, Yin and Yoo Warren imagined a woodworking class to recreate the wooden stools found throughout China Alley. Participants experienced the textures and scents of this craft, learned history with their hands, and kept a piece of Hanford in their homes for years to come. The featured photographs come from both the Hanford and LA workshops, photo credit Evelyn Hang Yin.



Together Shovel

A reproduction of a shovel based on archival photos and film from early 1900s Korea. The Together Shovel was used collaboratively: a group of people is able to shovel more in synchrony than they would be able to with individual shovels. Building and using a replica is a form of *relational reconstruction* in practice.



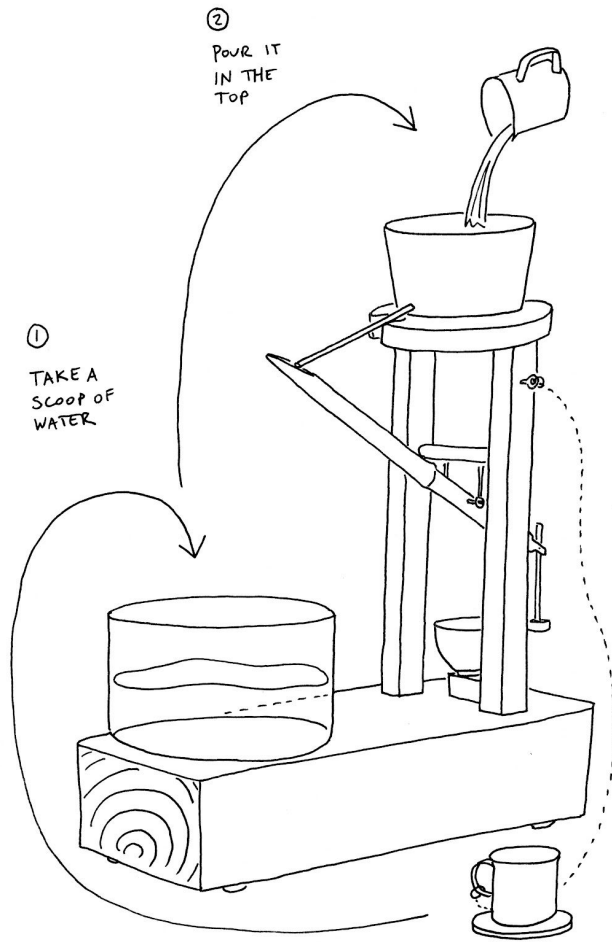


POTTICKY CARRIER: SEOUL, KOREA



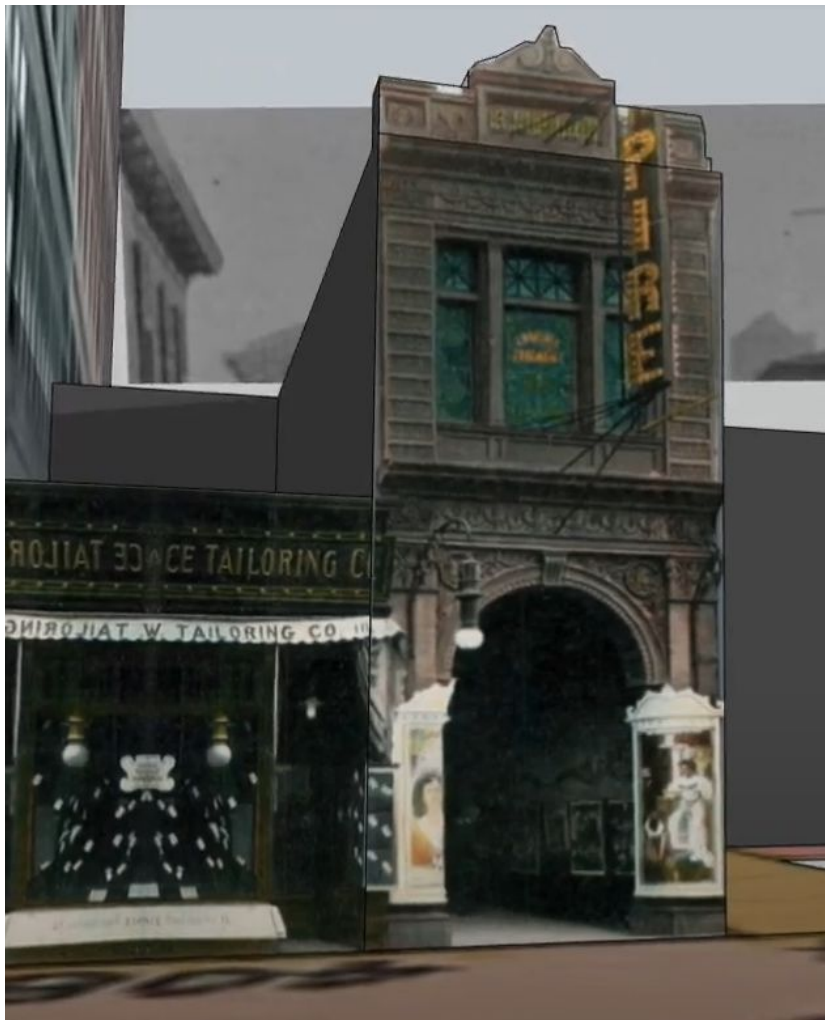
지게 Jigae Workshop

A 지게 jigae is a wooden backpack or carrying frame used by our ancestors in Korea; some are still in use in rural areas. In this workshop, participants learned how to build one. Practicing the crafts and experiencing the sensory worlds of our ancestors in creative ways is a powerful mode of reconnection and an opportunity to learn about ourselves as well. Supported by the Korean American Artist Collective & hosted at GOBI Los Angeles.



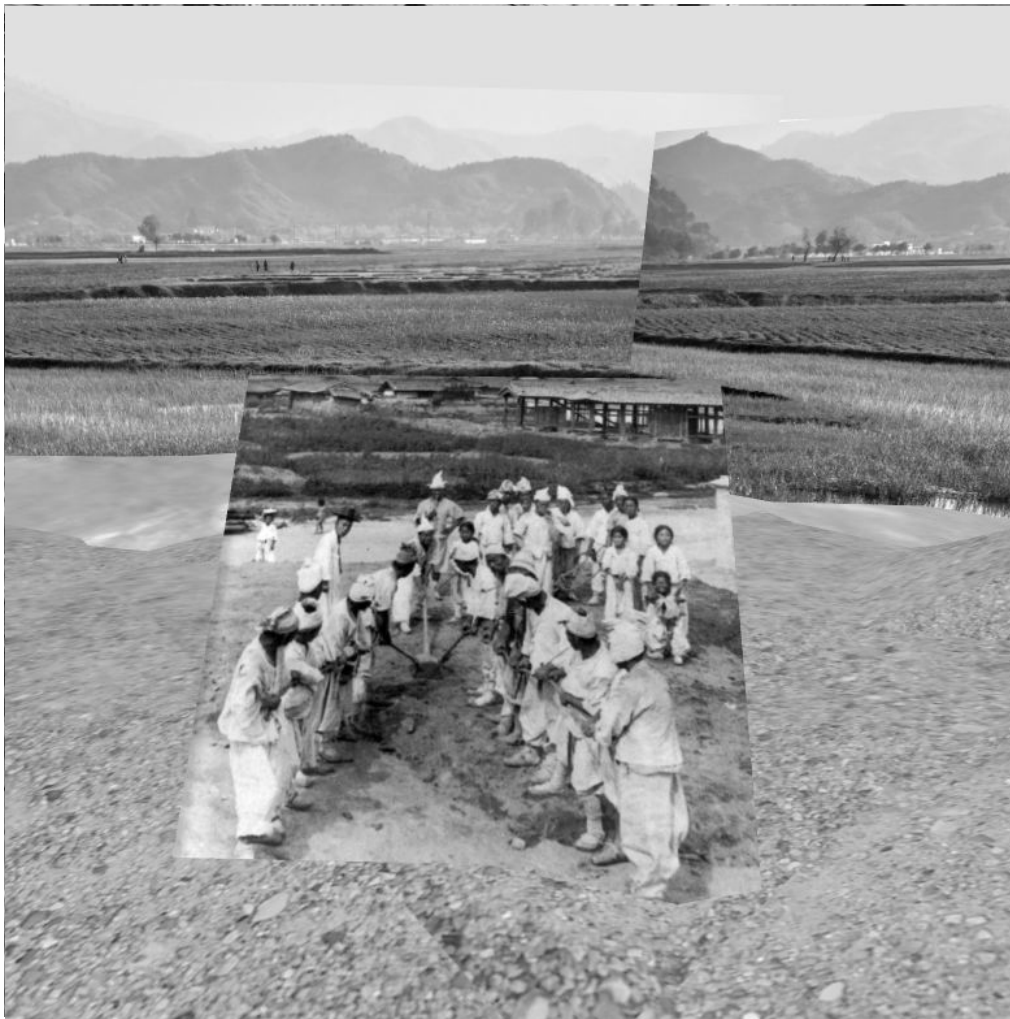
Mechanism for healing oneself with water

Originally imagined for my mother, takes inspiration from 자격루 / jageongnu, a self-striking water clock made by Jang Yeong-sil in 1434. This interpretive replica uses the weight of a cup of water, lifted by the user, to ring a singing bowl, producing 5 minutes of mindful space.



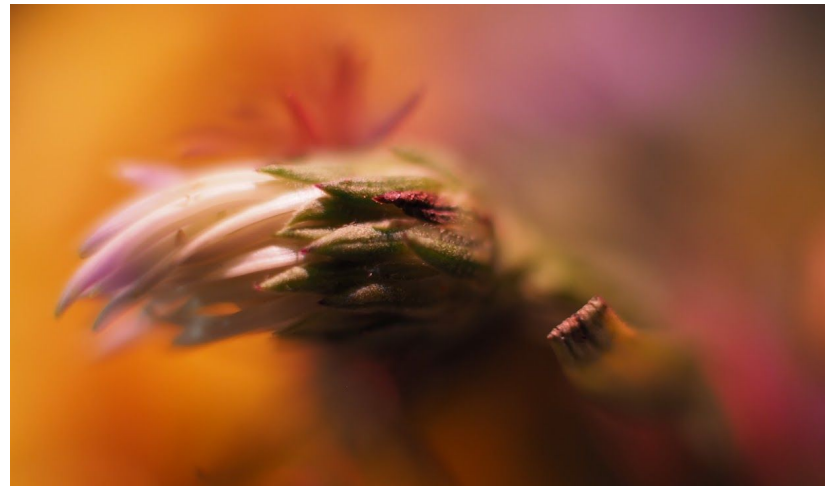
Seeing Providence Chinatown

The first phase of the broader project, "Seeing Lost Enclaves: relational reconstructions of erased historic neighborhoods of color," this archival research project laid the groundwork for an immersive virtual reconstruction of the erased Providence Chinatown neighborhood in the year 1910.



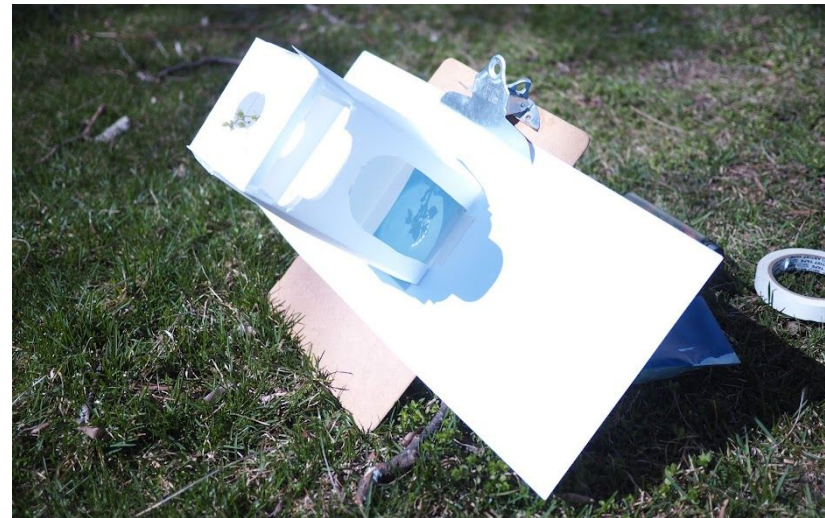
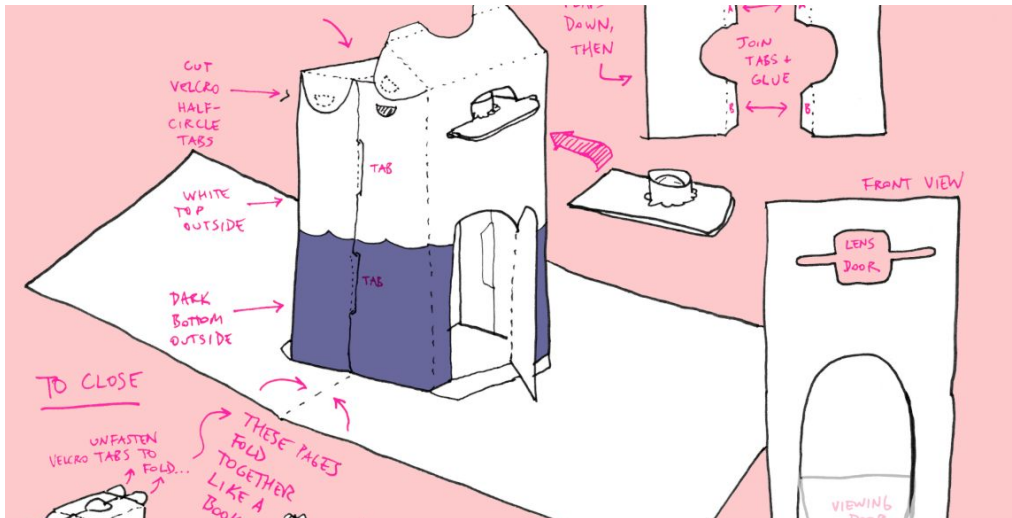
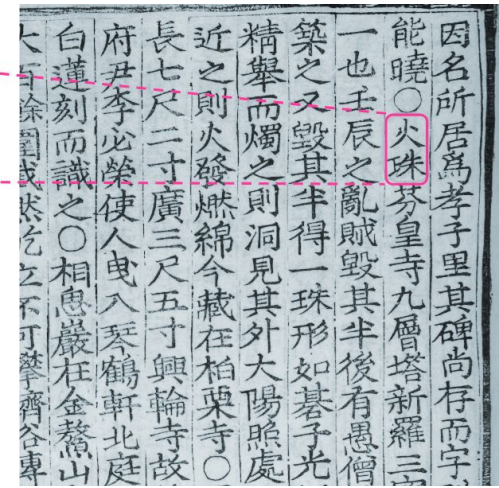
Ancestral Memory Enclaves

Offered in workshop format with CultureHub NYC in spring of 2022 in collaboration with Ann Chen, Ancestral Memory Enclaves are a more narrowly focused *relational reconstruction* methodology for creating a speculative “moment” or virtual space, based around a family or archival photograph with which one seeks a deeper relationship, through spatiality, texture, and soundscape.



Preciousness and Power

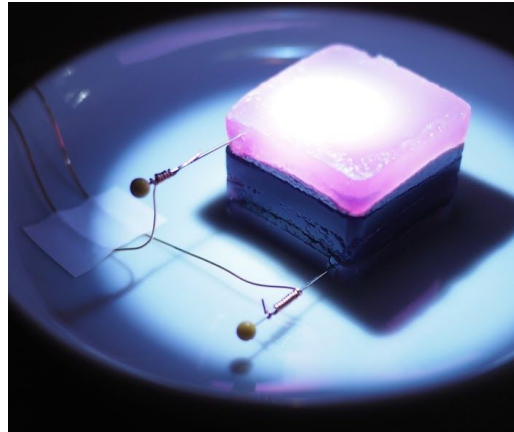
A 2020 video essay on being and belonging in a knowledge-world of closeness, intimacy, comfort, and strength, rather than distance and analysis; on being close with POC memories and identities at a microscopic scale, on traditions, histories, and protective layers of inscrutability, on anti-assimilation.



MICROCOSMOS

Participants build a microscope based on a 7th century Korean artifact, craft short microscopic audiovisual narratives, and reflect on non-eurocentric, non-masculine ways of seeing and knowing. 7th century records in Korea describe a 火珠 hwaju, or “fire pearl”

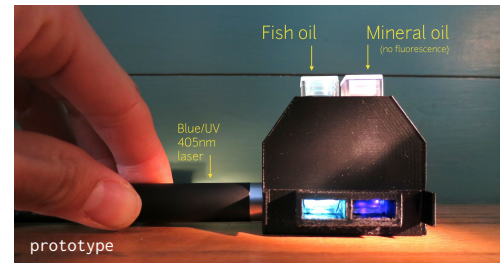
- an artifact shaped “like a Go stone” that we would know today as a lens. In this workshop, we use a replica of this artifact to build a papercraft microscope that might have existed then. 6 iterations have run with ~50 participants.



A 2020-2022 collection of projects which prototype culturally situated knowledge production in a world where dominant culture collapses all meanings into one lineage. Each instrument explores ways of “tuning into” that build on non-eurocentric, non-masculine

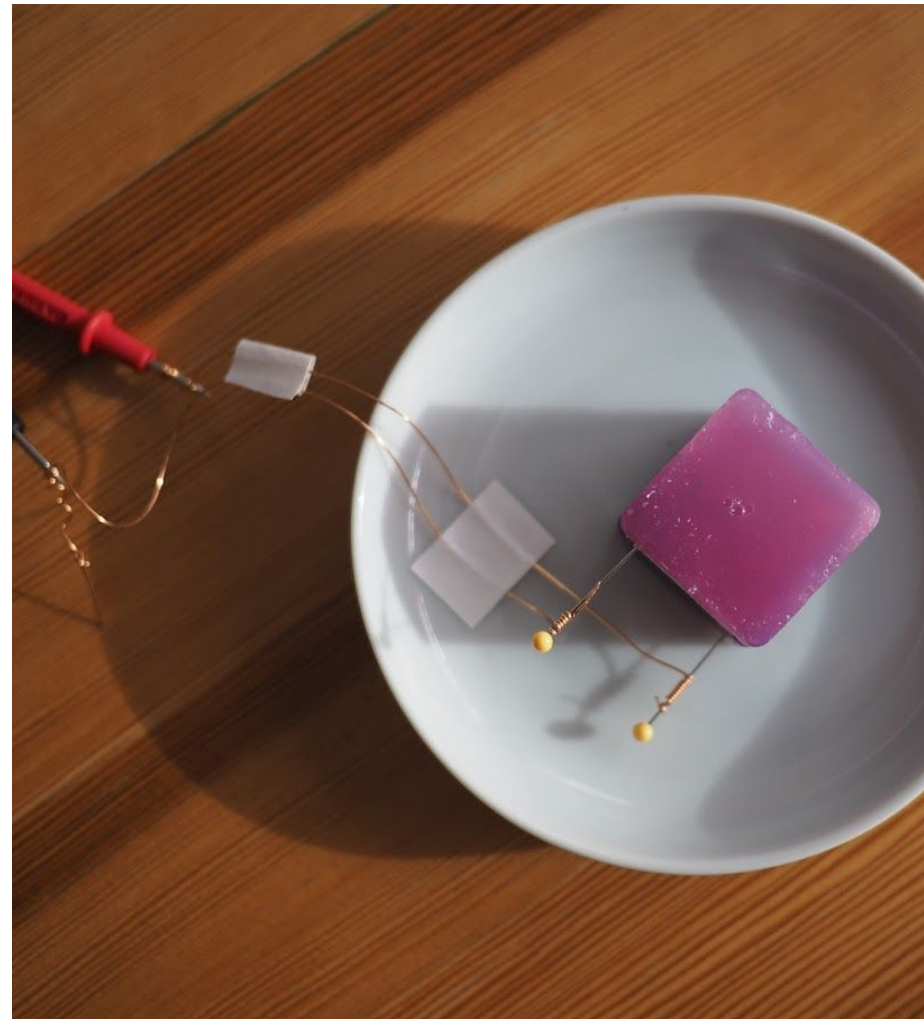
Instruments for Multiple Worlds

histories, and so may not speak to all audiences. Instead these instruments invite intimacy with hidden landscapes, or shared secrets hiding in plain sight - like a fourth color, or an untranslatable word.



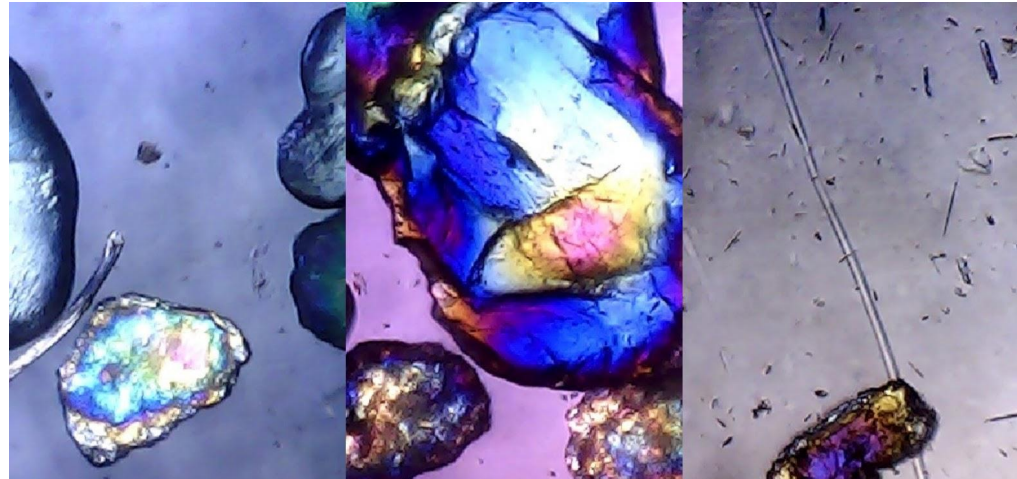
Porcelain Spectrometer

2019. Modeled on Joseon period Korean ceramic inkpots, this desktop spectrometer is made of porcelain and lined with felt. I was inspired to “recover” and remake scientific instruments from alternative histories, and especially ones that might not be recognized by today's scientists of dominant cultures.



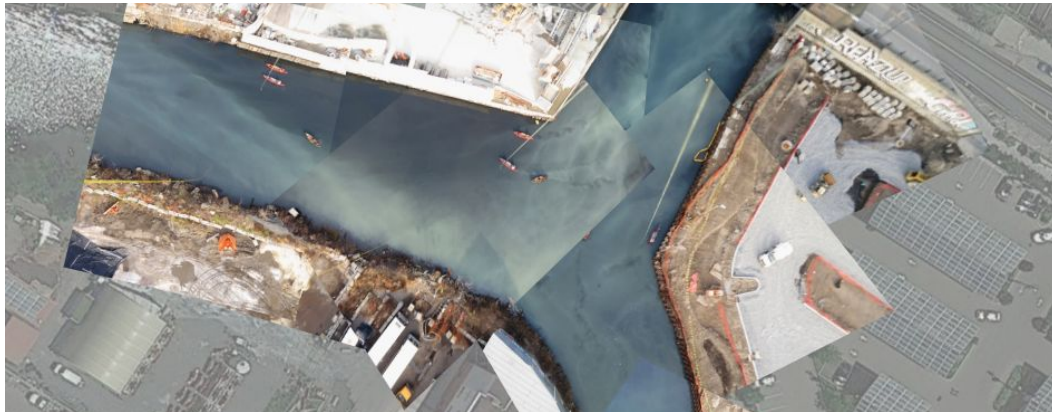
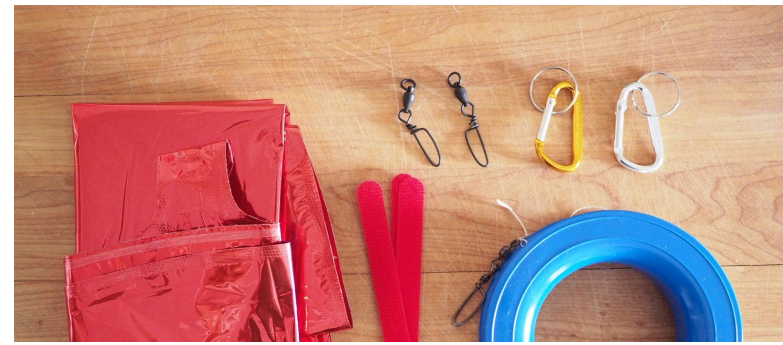
Solar Muk

This project, as a part of the Instruments for Multiple Worlds series, adapts traditional Korean grain-based gelatin techniques called *muk* in the creation of an organic solar cell, which will power a light-sensitive sonic synthesizer.



Community Microscope Kit

An affordable microscope kit made of everyday materials that can be assembled in 30m, it can photograph 2.5-10 micron air pollution particles. Lowering the barrier to microscopy creates a tool for collecting invisible environmental evidence in visual form. Designed collaboratively at Public Lab.



Balloon and Kite mapping

Balloon and kite mapping is a community-based DIY way to photograph environmental problems from the air, by carrying your camera over 1000 feet above your neighborhood to create accountability through community monitoring. Between 2010-2020 it was used by thousands of people around the world, and featured in a wide variety of museums and publications. Collaboratively developed at Public Lab.



Papercraft Spectrometry Kit

A materials analysis attachment for smartphones made of paper, which all ages can build themselves at workshops, changing the circle of possible contributors to this technology and the meaning and purpose of the tool. An estimated 80k have been distributed around the world since 2012, and a cut-out design was featured in the final issue of Make Magazine in 2019; featured in Lead designer.



Infragram plant camera

This infrared camera comes with software to analyze plant health, based on NASA techniques. Using a cardboard VR headset, it can be used immersively to re-color the world to highlight photosynthetic activity in real-time. Used on the International Space Station and in thousands of homes around the world. Collaboratively developed at Public Lab for wetlands analysis.